PersianPulse

MYTH CHECK

Do carrots sharpen your eyesight?

What the evidence says about vitamin A and vision

THE MYTH ~~Eating lots of carrots gives you sharper eyesight.~~

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS

Vitamin A is critical for vision, and carrots supply provitamin A. The link is about not running short: night blindness is the first sign of deficiency.

459 mcg
vitamin A (RAE) in ½ cup of raw carrot, 51% of the Daily Value

12 : 1
mcg of dietary beta-carotene counted as 1 mcg RAE

< 1%
of the US population had low serum retinol in NHANES data

> **Carrots are one good source of provitamin A. The evidence ties vitamin A to vision through deficiency, not to super-sight.**

Sources: NIH Office of Dietary Supplements, Vitamin A fact sheet (health professionals)
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